

Consistent SpellFixer

Are there multiple ways to spell a word in your language? Do you need to be able to standardize on a single form? Then Consistent SpellFixer (part of SILConverters) is a tool that can help you.

The tool will load your text corpus from SFM files (e.g. Paratext). Then it will show similarly spelled words in bundles like this:

Choose Correct Spelling						
File View						
Vemacular	Transliteration	Count	Click if both correct	Vemacular	Transliteration	Count
घाटिआ	misspelled word gātiā	1	Select	घाटिआ	same word gātiā	6
घात्तिआ	gātiā	1	Select	घाटिआ	same word gātiā	6
दस्त	dasta	1	Select	दुस्त	dasta	1
चक्खेआ	cakēā	1	Select	चुक्केआ	cakēā	7
कदोर्लाओमेर	kadorlāomēra	1	Select	कदोर्ला-ओमेर	kadorlāomēra	4
मितर	mitara	2	Select	मितर	mitara	4
मीटर	mitara	1	Select	मितर	mitara	4

Then you choose which spelling is the one you want to standardize on by clicking on the form you want (left- or right-hand side, OR both may be valid).

When you save the results, a Consistent Changes (CC) table will be created which you can use to process your corpus to make the spelling changes.

Choose Correct Spelling						
File View						
Vemacular	Transliteration	Count	Click if both correct	Vemacular	Transliteration	Count
घाटिआ	gātiā	1	→	घाटिआ	gātiā	6
घात्तिआ	gātiā	1	Select	घाटिआ	gātiā	6
दस्त	dasta	1	Select	दुस्त	dasta	1
चक्खेआ	cakēā	1	Select	चुक्केआ	cakēā	7
कदोर्लाओमेर	kadorlāomēra	1	←	कदोर्ला-ओमेर	kadorlāomēra	4

Cheat sheet for Consistent SpellFixer

- Basic Procedure:
 1. Install *SILConverters 5.4.** or newer.
 2. Open the *Bulk SFM Converter*
 3. Click the *File, Open SFM Documents, Unicode* menu.
 4. Select all the SFM Documents you have in your corpus (e.g. all the SFM documents in, say, C:\My Paratext 9 Projects\<project> folder). You might not want to include any that don't have words you want to check the spelling of.
 5. Click on the *Consistent Spelling Options* menu, and the *Select Consistent Changes Project...* menu. If there are no projects shown, then click the *Add New Project* button.
 6. Fill in the information (contact silconverters_support@sil.org for help depending on the language family you are using, but often the defaults can be used).
 7. Once you select the project and click *OK*, the converter for the SFM markers commonly having data that needs to be spell checked will be initialized with the name of the converter used for fixing bad spellings (e.g. *Consistent Spelling for Kangri*) so that the data in those markers will be checked for similar spelling. You can click on the center column buttons if you want to include other fields that aren't initialized (they'll say "Click to check spelling" if they're not initialized).
 8. Click on the *Consistent Spelling Options* menu again, and the *Analyze Data for Consistent Spelling* menu. This will launch another dialog (see examples below) that will have similarly spelled words in one or more rows in bundles of ambiguous words. This dialog loads in the background, but you may have to wait for it to finish before beginning the selecting process discussed below:
- Some rows of the table have bigger spaces above and below. All the rows inside the bigger space boundaries are "ambiguous" with each other. It might be a single row of a left and right word that are ambiguous with each other, or it might be multiple rows where the right-hand side word of all rows in the 'bundle' is the same word and is the most frequently used spelling (and therefore more likely might be the correct spelling of one or more of the words on the left). The left-hand side words are the various other words that are part of the same ambiguous bundle:

Choose Correct Spelling						
File View						
Vernacular	Transliteration	Count	Click if both correct	Vernacular	Transliteration	Count
घाटिआ	misspelled word gātiā	1	Select	घाटिआ	same word gātiā	6
घात्तिआ	gātiā	1	Select	घाटिआ	same word gātiā	6
दस्त	dasta	1	Select	दुस्त	dasta	1
चक्खेआ	cakēā	1	Select	चुक्केआ	cakēā	7
कदोर्लाओमेर	kadorlāomēra	1	Select	कदोर्ला-ओमेर	kadorlāomēra	4
मितर	mitara	2	Select	मितर	mitara	4
मीटर	mitara	1	Select	मितर	mitara	4

- Hover your cursor over the words in either the left or right-hand side *Vernacular* column to see a yellow popup window in upper left corner of screen showing some of the contexts in which the word appears:

दक्खण पास्से यरदन देआए दिआ घाटिआ देआं आस्से-पास्से देआं नगरां
 25 कने तिसा सारिआ घाटिआ जा, नगरां कने तिस
 भई सदोम, अमोरा कने तिसा घाटिआ दे सारे लाक्के च
 दिआ बहूजा ते परमेसरै तिसा घाटिआ देआं नगरां जो नास
 चला गेआ, कने गरार दिआ घाटिआ व अपणै बसेरा बणाई
 दे दास तिहूथु (गरार दिआ घाटिआ व) इक नीआ खुह

Transliteration	Count	Click if both correct	Vernacular	Transliteration	Count
	1	Select	घाटिआ	gātiā	6
	1	Select	घाटिआ	gātiā	6

- The Count column value indicates relative frequency of words (up to 20, but this is configurable in the project file, search for the *MaxContextStringsInToolTip* attribute in the <projectName>.csf file, located in by default in the *C:\ProgramData\SIL\ConsistentSpellingFixer\Projects\<projectName>* folder to change this value).
- Left click on the words in the *Vernacular* column to indicate that either the left or right-side word is the correct spelling of the other. This will put an arrow pointing to the correctly spelled word in the center column and make the good spelling show as green color and the bad spelling word as red:

Choose Correct Spelling						
File View						
Vemacular	Transliteration	Count	Click if both correct	Vemacular	Transliteration	Count
घाटिआ	gātiā	1	→	घाटिआ	gātiā	6
घात्तिआ	gātiā	1	Select	घाटिआ	gātiā	6
दस्त	dasta	1	Select	दुस्त	dasta	1
चक्खेआ	cakēā	1	Select	चक्केआ	cakēā	7
कदोर्लाओमेर	kadorlāomēra	1	←	कदोर्ला-ओमेर	kadorlāomēra	4

- If both words are correct, then left-click (once) on the word “Select” in the center column and you’ll get a double-headed arrow:

Choose Correct Spelling						
File View						
Vemacular	Transliteration	Count	Click if both correct	Vemacular	Transliteration	Count
घाटिआ	gātiā	1	→	घाटिआ	gātiā	6
घात्तिआ	gātiā	1	↔	घाटिआ	gātiā	6

- You can left-click again on the center button to undo a selection made previously.
- If a word (usually on the left) is bad, but the word on the right is not the correction of it, you can do one of two things:
 - If it’s a multi-line bundle of ambiguities, you can right-click on the correctly spelled word in the left-hand side (of some bad spelled word somewhere else either on the left or right-hand side) and the word you click on will become the new right-hand side word for each row. This allows you to then click on the new correctly spelled word on the right-hand side that’s the correction of one or more of the words on the left-hand side.
For example, suppose that before right-clicking on the left-hand side word, the situation was as this:

कहड़े good	kahadē	1	Select	खहड़े	kahadē	8
कहड़े bad	kahadē	1	Select	खहड़े	kahadē	8

One of these left-hand words is the correction of the other, while the right-hand word has no relationship to them. So you could right-click on the correctly spelled word in the left and that word will go to the right-hand side

After right-clicking on the good word on the left:

खहड़े	kahadē	8	Select	कहड़े good word	kahadē	1
कहड़े	kahadē	1	Select	कहड़े	kahadē	1

After the good word moves to the right-hand side, you can click on it in the 2nd row to show that it's the correct spelling of the left-hand side word in the 2nd row

खहड़े	kahadē	8	Select	कहड़े	kahadē	1
कहड़े	kahadē	1	→	कहड़े click here	kahadē	1

- If it's a single-line (or multiple-line) bundle of ambiguities (left and right side), and one of them is incorrect, but the other side is not the correction for it, you can right-click on the select button in the center to split the one row into two:

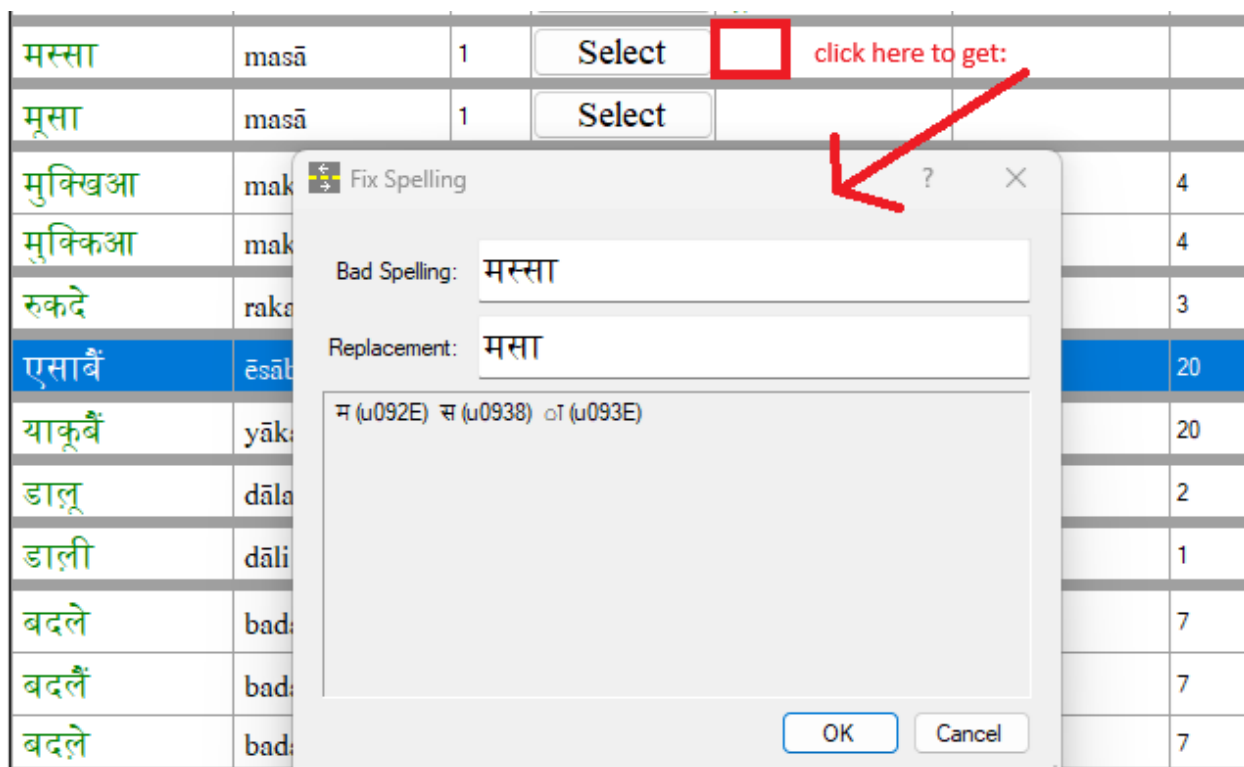
मस्सा	masā	1	Select	मूसा	masā	1
-------	------	---	--------	------	------	---

fake example, but suppose that this left-hand word was misspelled (suppose it should have been a single 's') but the right-hand word is unrelated. The solution is to right-click on the center button (that says 'Select') and that will split the one line into two lines:

After right clicking on the 'Select' button, you get:

मस्सा	masā	1	Select			
मूसा	masā	1	Select			

- Finally, you can right-click on the right-hand side Vernacular column (whether it is empty as here or if there is a word in the cell) to bring up the correction dialog:



Additional Notes:

- As you make selections in each row – whether one side is the correction of the other or both sides are valid words – it is best to work through all the ambiguous bundles before closing the dialog. And you should save your work often (by clicking on *File, Save*). Saving the work will remove the processed rows from the table. If you close the dialog (even if you do *File, Save and Exit*), it will reload all of the words that you’ve already processed in case you want/need to change your answer.
- It is important as you process a word as being the correction of another word that the bad spelling word is always bad. When you eventually go to correct the spelling of documents (e.g. the SFM documents you loaded), it will always change the bad spelling form to the good spelling form. So you don’t want to use this to correct two distinct words that you realize are different words and need to be separated.
- Again, contact silconverters_support@sil.org if you have any questions or need help setting it up.